

L E S S O N 0 4

What Repentance Actually Means

1: Sin and Salvation

Scripture Focus: Acts 3:19 · Luke 13:3 · Romans 10:9-10 · John 1:12

To receive God's salvation, we must respond in repentance and faith. Repentance is not merely feeling sorry for sin — it means to change one's mind and direction, a decisive turning from sin toward God. It goes hand-in-hand with trusting Christ alone to save us, and without it there is no forgiveness.

B Y T H E E N D

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to Acts 3:19 and Luke 13:3 and Romans 10:9-10 and John 1:12.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

V O C A B U L A R Y

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.

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Repentance	A Spirit-enabled change of mind and direction: turning from sin and toward God with faith-filled obedience.
Salvation	God's gracious rescue of sinners through the finished work of Christ, received by faith rather than earned by works.
Faith	Trusting God's Word and relying on Christ rather than self, merit, feeling, or religious performance.
Eternal Life	The life God gives in Christ; not temporary religious improvement, but secure life with Him that cannot be exhausted.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see repentance from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. To receive God's salvation, we must respond in repentance and faith. Repentance is not merely feeling sorry for sin — it means to change one's mind and direction, a decisive turning from sin toward God. It goes hand-in-hand with trusting Christ alone to save us, and without it there is no forgiveness.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

Acts 3:19 and Luke 13:3 and Romans 10:9-10 and John 1:12 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. In Romans 10:es 9 and 10, it says, If you confess with your mouth that Jesus is Lord and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. In addition to repentance, I must put my faith in Jesus Christ and him and him alone to save me. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

Acts 3:19

Acts 3:19 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read Acts 3:19 first, then read Luke 13:3 and Romans 10:9-10 and John 1:12. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

It's more than just I know Jesus Christ was God.

Study the passage:

- 1. What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
- 2. What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*
- 3. How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*

FRAMEWORK

Biblical Salvation vs. Common Assumption

BIBLICAL CATEGORY	COMMON CONFUSION
God defines the human problem before He reveals the rescue.	Sin is treated as a small mistake or comparison with other people.
Grace is received by faith because Christ has accomplished salvation.	Salvation is treated as something earned by moral effort.
Repentance and faith belong together in the believer's response.	Repentance is reduced to feeling bad or trying harder.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does repentance most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. For God so loved the world that he gave his only son that whoever believes in him should not perish but have eternal life. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. Acts 3:19 tells us, "Repent, therefore, and turn back that your sins may be blotted out." Also in Luke 13:3 we read, "No, I tell you, but unless you repent, you will also likewise perish." To receive God's salvation, we must respond in repentance. Biblical teaching should train the

believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

Repentance belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. Often times people think that repentance is just feeling sorry or just having a mindset of I feel bad about something. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **repentance should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **Acts 3:19 tells us, "Repent, therefore, and turn back that your sins may be blotted out." Also in Luke 13:3 we read, "No, I tell you, but unless you repent, you will also likewise perish." To receive God's salvation, we must respond in repentance.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

- 1. What should become clearer in your thinking about repentance?*

2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

3. *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about repentance. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

1. Use Acts 3:19 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

2. Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

3. Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.
